

JavaScript:

Though in the last several years, JavaScript is been increasingly used in server side scripting and software applications, going as far as iOS and Android apps, its primary use is that of a client-side scripting language designed for use in web browsers. Initially, its uses were mostly limited to interacting with forms, giving feedback to the user and detecting when they do certain things. `alert()` was used to notify the user of something, `confirm()` to ask if something is OK to do or not and either `prompt()` or a form field to get user input. But it was only after browsers started supporting the Document Object Model (DOM) that Javascript began to take shape into its present form.

The Mozilla Foundation documents define the DOM as “a programming interface for HTML and XML documents. It provides a representation of the document as a structured group of nodes and objects that have properties and method”. In a very abstract definition, this model was created to provide a convenient structure for programs to change document structure, style and content, with the program being a script in most cases.



A Javascript `alert()` box

Javascript is slightly tougher to master, compared to HTML and CSS. While using frameworks like JQuery allows you to hide behind a layer of abstraction and achieve certain effects in just a few lines of code, you'll most likely end up with a very limited knowledge of Javascript. You'll be able to perform simple rollovers and slideshows, but run into big problems once real DOM manipulation comes into play. But if your primary aim is not to get into webpage/webapp development, but to simply get your page up and running with minimal external effects, you can understand the basics of JQuery and get away with it. But it